NEPAL PARICHAYA SERIES · VOLUME IV

Nepal Parichaya: Federal Governance

Three-Tier State Architecture, Seven Provinces, and 753 Local Levels

Administrative Reference Compendium

Governance Edition · 4 Pages

UNIT I · COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM

Coexistence, Cooperation, and Coordination

Article 56 and Article 232 of the Constitution establish relations among Federal, Provincial, and Local levels on the principles of cooperation, coexistence, and coordination.

State power in Nepal is exercised across three autonomous yet interdependent spheres: the Federation, seven Provinces, and 753 Local Levels across 77 administrative districts.

UNIT II · SEVEN PROVINCES

Provincial Capitals and District Distribution

- Koshi Province — Capital: Biratnagar · 14 Districts · Area: 25,905 sq. km.
- Madhesh Province — Capital: Janakpurdham · 8 Districts · Area: 9,661 sq. km.
- Bagmati Province — Capital: Hetauda · 13 Districts · Area: 20,300 sq. km.
- Gandaki Province — Capital: Pokhara · 11 Districts · Area: 21,504 sq. km.
- Lumbini Province — Capital: Deukhuri · 12 Districts · Area: 22,288 sq. km.
- Karnali Province — Capital: Birendranagar · 10 Districts · Area: 27,984 sq. km.
- Sudurpashchim Province — Capital: Godawari · 9 Districts · Area: 19,874 sq. km.

UNIT III · LOCAL GOVERNMENT

Classification of the 753 Local Levels

- 6 Metropolitan Cities (Mahanagarpalika): Kathmandu, Lalitpur, Pokhara, Bharatpur, Birgunj, and Biratnagar.
- 11 Sub-Metropolitan Cities (Upamahanagarpalika) and 276 Municipalities (Nagarpalika).
- 460 Rural Municipalities (Gaunpalika) divided into 6,743 Wards nationwide serving as doorstep service centers.